

How to Achieve National Master and National Arbiter Titles

National Master (NM): This title is awarded by the CFC to players who have achieved a regular rating of at least 2200 and who have also achieved a performance rating of at least 2300 in three CFC events. Players may apply directly to the CFC but I am more than happy to receive them from players and shepherd them to the correct person at the CFC. The National Master title is granted for life and comes with a certificate suitable for framing.

National Arbiter (NA): This is the qualification needed to be arbiter for a FIDE rated event where title norms are not available. For events that are only CFC rated, the tournament director does not need to have this qualification. The title is awarded by the CFC and FIDE is notified.

The criteria for becoming a National Arbiter have varied somewhat over the years. At the 2023 CFC AGM, our FIDE Representative, Victor Plotkin who screens applications for both NM and NA titles tabled the following criteria which was generally agreed:

An NA applicant must have one (1) of the following:

- a) 2 recommendations from **IA/FAs** based on tournament experience
- b) 3 recommendations from
 - a. an **IA/FA** and
 - b. the **Provincial president** and
 - c. an **NA** based on tournament experience
- c) an **NA seminar with a test** and
 - a. 1 recommendation from an **IA/FA** based on tournament experience
- d) an **NA seminar with a test** and
 - a. 2 recommendations from
 - i. the **Provincial President** and
 - ii. an **NA** based on tournament experience.

An NA applicant must have both of the following experience requirements.

- a) At least 10 tournaments as an arbiter or an organizer.
- b) At least 20 tournaments as an arbiter, organizer, and/or player.

The process to submit application for FIDE NA Canada.

1. Complete the stated requirements.
2. Submit a request to the BCCF President or directly to the CFC FIDE Representative.
3. There will be a brief BCCF and CFC review process.
 - a. If approved, the CFC FIDE Representative will submit to FIDE for processing.

- b. The CFC will advise the candidate.
- 4. The BCCF will cover the FIDE fee (20 euros).

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